

Web camera stopped working

Q. I have Windows 98 installed on my machine. The Web camera installed on my system was working perfectly until recently—it just doesn't activate anymore. I tried re-installing the drivers, but the installation failed. The camera is not detected when I plug it in either. I have checked the BIOS, and found the USB port is enabled. I also tried installing another camera, but even that wasn't detected. Finally, I installed my camera on another system and found that it works perfectly. What do I do?

Narender Negi

A. Now that you've narrowed down the possibilities, we suspect that the USB port is the culprit. As you have already checked it is enabled, the port is probably malfunctional. To be doubly sure, you can install a version of Windows with better USB support, such as Windows XP. If the problem persists, your USB port is definitely kaput! You are then left with two options—either buy new USB ports with cables that connect to the USB header on your motherboard (if your motherboard has such headers), or buy a USB PCI card for new USB ports to connect your devices to.

Tweaking Windows XP

Q. I have an AMD Athlon XP 1700+ with Asus-A7V8X motherboard, 256 MB DDR 266 RAM and run Windows XP as the operating system. The problem is that my machine takes a very long time to boot up.

Santosh Choudhury

A. Anytime an operating system is booting up, it requires time to load device drivers, start-up programs, etc. The loading time is further dependent on devices being initialised by their drivers. Sometimes a slow device such as an external modem can increase boot up time. Windows XP is a big step forward from previous versions—it brings along a lot of excess baggage in terms of services that start when you boot. To reduce the boot up time, you can use tweaking utilities such as bootvis, available at <http://www.microsoft.com/whdc/hwdev/platform/performance/fastboot/bootvis.msp>. If you want more information on how to tweak Windows XP to improve performance, take a look at the *Tips & Tricks special* that came along with the June 2003 issue of Digit.

Too many drives

Q. I have a Athlon XP 2000+ processor, 40 GB Seagate hard disk, 128 MB DDR RAM, ASUS motherboard and run Windows 2000 Professional. I also have a Sony 52X CD-ROM and an LG 48X CD-Writer. Recently, I bought a 16X DVD-ROM. The problem is that my vendor says it's not possible to install all three at the same time, reason being that the PC won't be able to locate both, the DVD-ROM as well as CD-ROM at the same time. Is this true? If yes, what is the solution?

Dipanshu Banerjee

A. PCs are normally limited to four IDE devices. From the information that you have provided, you already have a hard disk, CD-ROM and CD-Writer installed. This leaves one IDE connector to which you can connect your DVD-ROM. If you do not have a free IDE connector, then you need to buy a combination drive that accommodates both a CD-Writer and a DVD-ROM. Use of a splitter in case you do not have a spare power connector for the drive. Also, you might run short of drive bays. Some cabinets have only two bays for optical drives. If so, you will have to buy a new cabinet with three bays.

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